

**CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 5**

Policy: 501.05 EMS Response

11/2023

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Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that the City of Calimesa Fire Department being “all-risk” will efficiently and correctly respond to any type of incident in a safe and timely manner. With an area of diverse incidents EMD will provide responding apparatus the EMD MPDS response determinants that will state who responds, with or without lights and sirens, type of incident and specials factors like staging.

Policy

The Fire Service is a diverse organization that is called upon to respond to many different types of “all-hazard incidents” incidents. The following is the Riverside County EMD MPDS response determinants that dictate how the apparatus responds.

Omega (non-injury) – Public Service Assist (PSA) or Basic Life Support (BLS) with no lights or sirens (either 1 fire apparatus or ambulance)

Alpha (low priority)– BLS without lights and sirens (1 fire apparatus and 1 ambulance)

Bravo (mid priority) – BLS/ALS with lights and sirens (1 fire apparatus and 1 ambulance)

Charlie (critical) – Advanced Life Support (ALS) with lights and sirens (1 fire apparatus and 1 ambulance)

Delta (life-threatening) – ALS with lights and sirens (multi apparatus and at least 1 ambulance)

Echo (Imminent death or special circumstances) – ALS with lights and sirens (multi apparatus and/or specialty apparatus and at least 1 ambulance)

Responding – Enroute (with or without lights and sirens)

- Apparatus operators responsibilities are to comply with driving safety policy.
- Apparatus operators responsibilities are to comply with apparatus checkout policy.
- Full application of all emergency lighting and siren is considered code 3.
- Apparatus operators responsibilities are to ensure all parties are seated and seat belted.
- Apparatus operators while responding to an incident with lights and sirens (code 3) will abide by the vehicle code.
- The posted speed limit shall be observed and under no circumstances shall the apparatus exceed a speed considered safe for the road conditions, traffic and visibility.
- All intersections will be approached as if they are blind and come to a speed where both sides of the apparatus can be cleared safely and proceed no greater than 5 mph through the intersection.
- Apparatus should only pass traffic on the left hand side. Extreme caution must be exercised when circumstances dictate passing on the right hand side.

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- Passing in the opposite direction or opposing traffic should be avoided. Extreme caution must be exercised when circumstances dictate opposing traffic.
- Apparatus operator should reduce any occasion to back by spotting to forward exit.
- A spotter should be utilized whenever possible.
- Apparatus operator is ultimately responsible and should follow City of Calimesa Fire Department backing policy.

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Purpose

The City of Calimesa Fire Department personnel will use recognized safe practices and accepted standards of care when dealing with body fluids and respiratory exposure. This plan has been developed to comply with Cal OSHA's Bloodborne Pathogens Standard and Aerosol Transmissible Disease Standard.

Policy

Personnel will select personal protective equipment (PPE) appropriate to the potential exposure and attempt to limit the number of members who might be exposed to blood or other potentially infectious materials on an incident.

Other potentially infectious materials include:

- Cerebrospinal fluid (CSF)
- Synovial fluid
- Pleural fluid
- Pericardial fluid
- Peritoneal fluid
- Amniotic fluid
- Semen
- Vaginal secretions
- Saliva
- Body fluids that are visibly contaminated with blood.
- Body fluids in situations where it is difficult or impossible to differentiate between body fluids.
- Unfixed tissue or organ (other than intact skin) from a human (living or dead)
- HIV containing cell or tissue cultures, organ cultures.
- HBV containing cell or tissue cultures, organ cultures.
- Positive or suspected persons with Covid

PPE will be considered appropriate only if it does not permit blood or other potentially infectious materials to pass through to or reach the member's work uniform, undergarments, skin, eyes, mouth, or mucous membranes under working field conditions. PPE must be replaced whenever it is known or suspected to be compromised. Each apparatus has been provided with an EMS bag that carries the necessary PPE for exposure prevention. These should be worn on EMS incidents and procedures involving excess amounts of blood, or other potentially infectious materials. Actions should be taken into consideration to minimize splashing, spraying, spattering, or generation of droplets of these substances. Biohazardous materials from an incident such as saturated gauze, used sharps, any item introduced into a patient and contaminated equipment should be contained in a red

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biohazardous bag and disposed of with other medical waste and the equipment decontaminated.

What is a Confirmed Infection/Exposure

- i. Contact with any of the above potentially infectious materials. Whenever the integrity of his/her universal precautions are breached, and a potentially infectious material(s) can come in contact with non-intact skin or mucous membranes.
- ii. An incident in which all of the following have occurred:
 - a. First responder personnel has been exposed to an individual who is a confirmed case or suspected case of a transmittable disease.
 - b. Exposure occurred without the benefit of applicable universal precautions.
 - c. It reasonably appears from the circumstances of the exposure that transmission of the disease is likely and is need of medical evaluation.
- iii. Personnel must immediately report to the Captain if one of the following occurs:
 - a. Mouth-to-mouth resuscitation without universal precautions.
 - b. Any eye, nose or mouth contact with a potentially infectious material.
 - c. Needle stick that breaches the skin.

Cross-contamination

To prevent cross- contamination personnel should remove their latex gloves in the correct manner prior to touching and/or carrying out the EMS equipment. All equipment on an infectious incident must be decontaminated in accordance to policy.

Universal Precautions

- i. PPE Selection
 - a. All personnel shall wear disposable gloves during any patient contact on all medical incidents.
 - b. Appropriate respiratory protection and fully covering eyewear will be donned anytime contamination potential is present.
 - c. Additional protective clothing such as a duty coat or brush coat will be donned anytime contamination potential is present and more coverage is needed.
- ii. Respiratory Protection
 - a. Disposable or non-disposable masks shall conform to Cal OSHA Standard 5199 and will be provided prior to a medical incident.
 - b. An N-95 mask shall be used when treating patients who may be suffering from the following: pneumonia, viral or bacterial meningitis, whooping cough, epiglottitis, TB, suspected or confirmed COVID and any novel or poorly understood respiratory infections. Will be provided prior to any medical incident.